



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	6 th January 2026	Time of Incident	09:30
Directorate / Region	RMO - Wheatbelt	Main Roads or Contractor	Main Roads WA
EQSafe Event Type	Injury/ Illness	EQSafe Incident Number	55952
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Moderate

Incident Short Description	Roadworker Slips on Road Shoulder
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Executive Summary

On 6th January 2026, the Roadworker (IP) and colleague were tasked to remove and install sign assemblies which were located at separate locations on a LGA road which was located approximately 30 minutes from the depot.

After the morning prestart meeting, the crew loaded the truck with materials for the day's tasks and then commenced the journey to site. Upon arriving at the site, the crew conducted an inspection of the works location from the cabin of the truck and completed a Take 5 for the task of installing a post and sign assembly.

The crew moved to the second location which was 15m from the first. The crew discussed the methodology of removing the signpost and the IP's colleague proceeded to cut the post using a reciprocating saw while the IP lowered the sign to the ground.

The IP assessed the dimensions of the signpost and as they began to lift the sign, the IP's left foot slipped from underneath them and they fell heavily onto their coccyx region. The IP's colleague attempted to assist the IP to their feet, but the IP was unable to move due to the pain.

An ambulance attended and they assessed the IP at the site before taking the IP to the local hospital for further assessment.



Scene of the incident. Red circle indicates the fall location

Contributing Factors

- Uncompacted ground conditions underfoot lead to the IP's foot slipping out from underneath them when weight was applied
- The crew did not identify that the ground conditions were unstable
- The IP failed to assess the ground conditions as per standard manual handling techniques prior to lifting the sign
- The crew failed to conduct a site assessment when moving to the second site. The failure to conduct this assessment meant the crew did not identify ground condition hazards as they differed from the first site
- The ground surface where the IP was standing was uncompacted, had a steep decline and was covered in vegetation
- The task of walking over road shoulders while carrying tools and /or materials is a regular occurrence for the maintenance crew. This could have been a matter of complacency as the IP had just completed a similar task 15 metres from the second work area
- The organisation has a sizable and complex safety management system which has been developed over time, including following incidents, and has not been assessed to ensure that the documentation is suitable to manage the risks.

Corrective Actions

- Roadworker crews to review SWMS at the time of conducting the task to ensure all hazards associate with the work scope have been identified and controlled
- Communicate findings, causal factors and corrective actions at toolbox meetings
- Conduct a formal audit of the safety management system documentation to ensure that all procedures effectively manage risks for Main Roads workers

Additional Issues / Learnings

- No additional learnings

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations